two LTTE members, Kanagasabapathy and Athirai (now already in custody). The latter was a human bomb and the head of the Black Tigress group of the LTTE. Dhanu and Shubha were trained under Athirai. Multiple sources confirmed the duo's visit to the Indian capital.

Further interrogation of the assassins led the SIT to believe that the duo had gone to Delhi as part of Plan B—killing Rajiv Gandhi in India's capital if the LTTE's Tamil Nadu mission failed. Although the SIT was not bound by the IB's 'findings', such claims did create confusion in the government that the investigators were accountable for. Some in the government, and at least two officers within the SIT, believed that Kaarthikeyan was 'determined to hold the LTTE as the lone and sole executor of the assassination, prove that in the court and secure the conviction of those already in his custody'. Therefore, anything outside the Tamil Tigers would not fall in his list of priorities. Naturally, forces that didn't see eye to eye with the SIT boss had started making noise. For Anirudhya, the source of the report was more intriguing. Both Athirai and Kanagasabapathy, being LTTE cadres from Jaffna, should have been on the radar of R&AW. Yet, their movements were tracked by the IB, and R&AW was nowhere in the picture.

When Anirudhya met the former director general (intelligence) of state police, Kondath Mohandas, at his apartment in Madras, he pointed to the 'intriguing circumstances' in which Sriperumbudur was added to Rajiv Gandhi's itinerary without consulting the state party chief Vazhappady Ramamurthy. He also mentioned the snag in the aircraft from Visakhapatnam, which was rectified immediately, making sure he made it to the rally. But these events were interpreted as 'destiny' by the SIT and Anirudhya's sources in the IB. It was clear from sources in the Congress party that Rajiv Gandhi was genuinely interested in campaigning for his 'Aunty (Maragatham) Chandrasekar'. But the former director general went on to cite more instances of 'oversight'. 'Yasser Arafat's warning to Rajiv Gandhi,' he said, 'should also be looked into. I strongly suspect that the LTTE was used as a front for some other organization.' However, the same Mohandas remained silent when asked why the LTTE was handled softly